

LEGACY

FOOD & DRINK





Dum Pukht, ITC Maurya, New Delhi—1989

The Art of Cooking in Slow Motion

If Bukhara is about fire, Dum Pukht is about time. The restaurant's story is inseparable from the late Chef Imtiaz Qureshi, who took the slow-cooking traditions of Awadh and translated them into the language of luxury dining. Food was sealed into heavy vessels and allowed to cook gently, giving meat, rice, spices and aromatics time to develop depth, flavour and flourish.

There were no shortcuts. And Qureshi understood something that almost feels like counter-culture today: waiting could itself be luxurious. His philosophy was wonderfully simple: "The recipes involve three things: meat, spices and the most important—timing." That final word is the essence of Dum Pukht.

The famous Dum Pukht Biryani, kebabs and Awadhi preparations became ambassadors for a cuisine that has famously travelled from royal kitchens to one of Delhi's most prestigious hotel dining rooms. There is something deeply luxurious about that journey. The dish is not hurried for the diner. The diner waits for the dish.

Signature Dum Pukht Biryani, Kakori Kebab and Awadhi specialities

The Dum Pukht lesson In a world obsessed with speed, time can be the most precious ingredient

Meal for Two ₹12,000 plus taxes

enjoying the dal so much that he reportedly said: "I wish I had two stomachs. Carry me in a stretcher to my room if you have to but I will have the bowl of dal." It is a wonderfully Bukhara moment. After Clinton's visit, the restaurant had acquired something no marketing campaign can manufacture: Mythology.

Then there are the accolades. Bukhara was named *Best Restaurant in Asia* and *Best Indian Restaurant in the World* by Restaurant magazine in 2004 and entered the World's 50 Best Restaurants list. Its philosophy of consistency has remained remarkably intact over the decades. Presidents have changed. Menus have barely changed. And perhaps that is the point.

Signature: Dal Bukhara, Sikandari Raan, Naan Bukhara

The Bukhara lesson Sometimes consistency is the ultimate luxury

Meal for Two ₹12,000 plus taxes



